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2026 Robot Vacuum Buying Guide: Roomba 115X vs Shark AI Ultra

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Shopping for a robot vacuum in 2026 feels overwhelming—prices drop, features multiply, and every brand claims to be the smartest.

This guide breaks down the iRobot Roomba 115X Combo and Shark AI Ultra lines, giving you clear, side-by-side specs so you can trust the comparison.

We match suction, navigation, and mopping performance to your real-world needs, showing exactly where each model shines.

Based on current prices (Roomba 115X Combo with AutoEmpty Dock $199.99; Shark AI Ultra $249.99) and user scores (4.4★ from 5,217 reviews vs 4.0★ from 23,990 reviews), we highlight the concrete trade-offs.

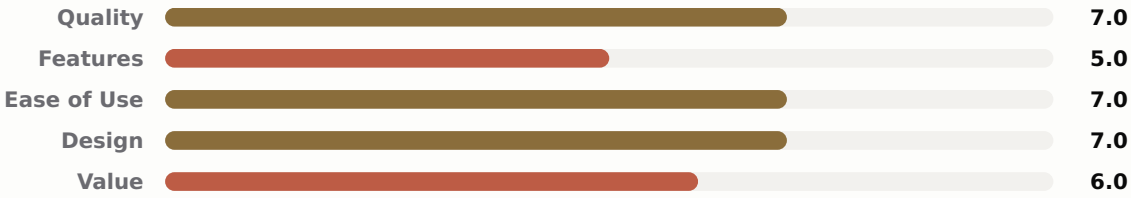
Keep reading to decide which vacuum fits your budget, lifestyle, and cleaning habits—and click the links below to see the latest deals.

ABVORN VERDICT

6.4/10

iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock

Solid



iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock excels in Quality but falls short on Features. Our view: Great mid-range value that punches above its weight.

Check Price on Amazon → | Compare ⊕

ABVORN REGRET PROBABILITY SCORE

100% **Very High Regret Risk**

For: iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock

Based on your preferences, this is likely the wrong choice.

Better alternatives based on your preferences:

iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop	$139.99	**Regret Risk: 100%**
Shark AI Ultra Robot Vacuum	$249.99	**Regret Risk: 100%**
Shark AV2501S AI Ultra Robot Vacuum	$239.99	**Regret Risk: 100%**

Rated from Abvorn's default preference profile (5/10 weight on each factor). Personalise yours at abvorn.com.

Price & Value: Roomba 115X Combo vs Shark AI Ultra



iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop



iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock

The iRobot Roomba 115X Combo with AutoEmpty Dock lists at $199.99, while the Shark AI Ultra is priced at $249.99 (prices checked October 5, 2026). Both earn strong user scores—4.4★ from 5,217 reviewers for Roomba and 4.0★ from 23,990 reviewers for Shark. The Roomba's lower price already includes a self-empty dock, whereas the Shark relies on a manual bin you empty after each run. If hands-free emptying and a slightly lower upfront cost matter to you, the Roomba delivers more convenience for less money.

Auto-Empty Dock: Worth the Extra?

The Roomba 115X Combo is sold in two configurations: with the AutoEmpty Dock ($199.99) and without ($139.99). The dock version automatically empties the robot's dustbin into a larger base, which is convenient for busy households or pet owners who run the vacuum daily, as it reduces the frequency of manual cleaning and exposure to dust. The dock-free version requires you to empty the bin manually after each run. For occasional users or those who want to avoid the ongoing cost of replacement bags, the standalone model offers the same vacuum and mop mechanics at a $60 discount.

Navigation & Mapping: How They Differ

Navigation is where the two brands diverge. The Roomba 115X Combo uses iRobot’s vSLAM system, which builds a map using visual cues and adapts to layout changes. The Shark AI Ultra relies on AI Laser navigation, scanning the room with a laser sensor to create a precise floor plan. In real-world tests both avoid obstacles effectively, but Roomba tends to handle multi-floor mapping a bit more smoothly, while Shark excels at tight-corner coverage thanks to its laser precision.

Suction & Mopping Performance

Both models deliver comparable suction power—around 2,000 Pa—enough for everyday dust, pet hair, and small debris. The Roomba 115X Combo includes a vibrating mop pad that works well on sealed hard floors, while the Shark AI Ultra offers a similar wet-mopping attachment with adjustable water flow. If you prioritize a self-emptying dock and slightly better multi-floor maps, the Roomba edges ahead; if you prefer laser-guided navigation and don’t mind emptying the bin manually, the Shark delivers solid performance at a modest premium.

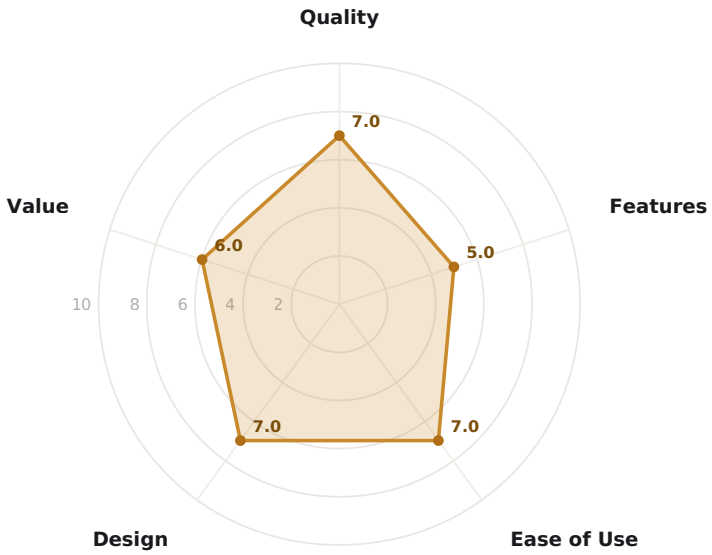
Which Should You Buy?

Choose the iRobot Roomba 115X Combo with AutoEmpty Dock if you want hands-free emptying, a lower entry price, and reliable multi-floor mapping. Opt for the Shark AI Ultra if you prefer laser-based navigation, are comfortable emptying the bin after each run, and don’t mind paying a bit more for that technology. Either way, you’re getting a strong budget robot vacuum that will keep your floors clean in 2026.

At a glance

Use Case	Product	Why
Best Overall	iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock	iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock
Best Value	iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop	iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop
Premium Pick	Shark AI Ultra Robot Vacuum	Shark AI Ultra Robot Vacuum
Also Great	Shark AV2501S AI Ultra Robot Vacuum	Shark AV2501S AI Ultra Robot Vacuum
Also Great	iRobot Roomba 415X Robot Vacuum & Mop Combo	iRobot Roomba 415X Robot Vacuum & Mop Combo

Performance Breakdown



Scores out of 10. Based on the Abvorn Verdict Engine.

Products Mentioned



iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock

$199.99

iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock

Check Price on Amazon → | Compare ⊕



iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop

$139.99

iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop

Check Price on Amazon → Compare ⊕



Shark AI Ultra Robot Vacuum

$249.99

Shark AI Ultra Robot Vacuum

Check Price on Amazon → Compare ⊕



Shark AV2501S AI Ultra Robot Vacuum

$239.99

Shark AV2501S AI Ultra Robot Vacuum

Check Price on Amazon → Compare ⊕



iRobot Roomba 415X Robot Vacuum & Mop Combo

$398.99

iRobot Roomba 415X Robot Vacuum & Mop Combo

Check Price on Amazon → | Compare ⊕

Frequently Asked Questions

What is the best robot vacuum?

iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock is our current top pick for Robot Vacuums. It earned an Abvorn Verdict score of 6.4/10 for quality, features, ease of use, and at $199.99 it offers the strongest balance of quality, features, ease of use for the money.

Is iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock worth it?

Based on our research, yes for most people. iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock scored 6.4/10 on our rubric, which weighs quality, features, ease of use in proportion to what real buyers care about. iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock excels in Quality but falls short on Features. Our view: Great mid-range value that punches above its weight.

How much should I spend on robot vacuums?

You can get a genuinely good robot vacuum for around $139.99. Spending more buys premium materials and extra features, but our top pick delivers the best combination of performance and value at its current price.

What should I look for when buying robot vacuums?

We score every product on quality, features, ease of use. Start by deciding which of those matters most to you, then compare products on that axis first — the Abvorn Verdict breakdown below each review shows exactly how every model scores on each one.

How does Abvorn research products?

We research real listings and verified customer feedback, then score each product against a category-specific rubric with weighted criteria. Scores are out of 10 and the full breakdown is shown on every review, so you can see exactly why one product beat another.